Ukraine's Starlink Is Back at Full Speed After a Week of Limits

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Ukraine's satellite internet is working at full speed again, after more than a week of connection problems. The news came on Saturday, when tech billionaire Elon Musk said his company SpaceX had **restricted** the service, and Ukraine's leaders said speeds were back where they needed to be.

Starlink is a network of **satellites** that beams internet down from low **orbit** around Earth. In Ukraine, it helps military units stay in touch, especially in remote areas where regular phone and internet networks do not reach. Ukraine also uses a separate, more secure system called **Starshield**, which is controlled by the United States government.

Musk said SpaceX had **restricted** Starlink because, in his view, Ukraine had broken the service's rules by using it for military activity. He also said SpaceX had done more to defend Ukraine than any private company on Earth. He denied being responsible for a problem with **Starshield** at the same time.

The connection trouble began last week, during a disagreement between Washington and Kyiv over Ukrainian strikes on oil sites inside Russia. United States President Donald Trump said he had told Musk to put the service back, after earlier denying that he had told him to limit it.

One Ukrainian official, Beskrestnov, pushed back. Writing on Telegram, he said Starlink **terminals** in Ukraine already had a speed limit of 70 to 90 kilometres per hour and did not work on Russian territory, so they physically could not be used for deep strikes.

Ukraine's defence minister, Yevhenii Khmara, said on Saturday that the military now had a stable connection, with drones able to reach speeds above 400 kilometres per hour. President Volodymyr Zelensky wrote that the speeds are now where they need to be. Musk did not explain in his post why SpaceX had made the change last week.

Word Treasure

satellites -- Machines that fly around Earth in space and send signals back down.

orbit -- The path an object follows as it travels around Earth.

terminals -- Small dishes on the ground that send and receive satellite signals.

Starshield -- A separate, more secure satellite system controlled by the United States government.

restricted -- Limited or held back on purpose.

Background you need

Satellite internet works by sending signals between small dishes on the ground and satellites flying in low orbit around Earth.

It can reach faraway places where phone lines and regular internet networks do not reach.

Armies also use it to stay in touch when they are far from towns and cities.

Break it down

WHO: Ukraine's military and leaders, SpaceX and Elon Musk, United States President Donald Trump, and Ukrainian official Beskrestnov.

WHAT: Starlink service in Ukraine was restricted and then restored to full speed.

WHERE: Ukraine.

WHY: Musk said Ukraine had broken the service's rules by using it for military activity, and the trouble began during a disagreement between Washington and Kyiv.

Why it matters

It shows how important a good internet connection is for staying in touch, just like when your own Wi-Fi drops at home.

Test what you remember

1. What is Starlink?

- (A) A kind of television channel
- (B) A network of satellites that beams internet down from low orbit around Earth
- (C) A weather balloon
- (D) A phone company

2. What happened after more than a week of connection problems?

- (A) Ukraine's satellite internet is working at full speed again
- (B) Ukraine banned all internet use
- (C) Ukraine built a new satellite
- (D) Ukraine's satellite internet stopped for good

3. Why did Musk say SpaceX had restricted Starlink?

- (A) Because Ukraine asked for slower speeds
- (B) Because the satellites broke
- (C) Because of bad weather in space
- (D) Because Ukraine had broken the service's rules by using it for military activity

4. What is Starshield?

- (A) A separate, more secure system controlled by the United States government
- (B) A new kind of drone
- (C) A satellite that takes photos of the Moon
- (D) A Ukrainian phone network

5. What did Beskrestnov say about Starlink terminals in Ukraine?

- (A) They only worked in cities
- (B) They already had a speed limit of 70 to 90 kilometres per hour and did not work on Russian territory
- (C) They could fly across whole countries
- (D) They had no speed limit at all

6. What did defence minister Yevhenii Khmara say on Saturday?

- (A) The military now had a stable connection, with drones able to reach speeds above 400 kilometres per hour
- (B) The military had lost all connection
- (C) The military had moved to a different country
- (D) The military had stopped using satellites

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: D 4: A 5: B 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Elon Musk: He said SpaceX restricted Starlink because, in his view, Ukraine had broken the service's rules by using it for military activity.

2. Beskrestnov: He said Starlink terminals in Ukraine already had a speed limit and did not work on Russian territory, so they physically could not be used for deep strikes.

3. Donald Trump: He said he had told Musk to put the service back.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):